Pulmonology Service Line Handbook

MERIDIAN HEALTH PARTNERS ## Department of Pulmonology Service Line Handbook Document Control: MHP-PLM-HB-042 Effective Date: 1 January 2025 Owner: Dr. Aris Thorne, Pulmonology Department Chair Applies To: All Pulmonology Department Personnel, Scheduling Agents, and Referral Coordinators

1. Purpose and Scope 1.1 This handbook establishes the operational, scheduling, and insurance administration policies for the Pulmonology Department across all 14 Meridian Health Partners outpatient clinic sites. 1.2 Referral turnaround times are governed exclusively by the Meridian Health Partners Referral Management Policy (MHP-OPS-POL-102); staff shall consult that document for processing windows.

2. Clinical Scope: Accepted and Unaccepted Conditions 2.1 Accepted Conditions: The department accepts outpatient referrals for chronic obstructive pulmonary disease (COPD), asthma, chronic bronchitis, bronchiectasis, interstitial lung disease, suspected sleep-disordered breathing, unexplained chronic cough, and exercise-induced dyspnoea. 2.2 Explicitly Not Accepted Conditions: The department does not accept direct referrals for acute status asthmaticus requiring emergency intervention, suspected active pulmonary tuberculosis, cystic fibrosis managed under pediatric subspecialty protocols, or patients requiring mechanical ventilation support. Such cases must be redirected immediately to acute-care hospital facilities via the Emergency Referral Protocol (MHP-OPS-POL-108).

3. Appointment Scheduling and Service Durations 3.1 First Appointment Commitment: The Pulmonology Department commits to offering a first appointment within exactly 8 days of receiving an accepted referral. 3.2 Service Durations: Pulmonology service durations are strictly fixed as follows: * Standard New-Patient Consultation (`PULM-CONS`): 30 minutes. * Pulmonary Function Test (`PULM-PFT`): 45 minutes. * Bronchoscopy (`PULM-BRON`): 60 minutes.

4. Patient Preparation Instructions 4.1 Consultation (`PULM-CONS`): Patients must bring a complete medication list, all prior thoracic imaging discs or digital access codes from the preceding 24 months, and a completed respiratory symptom diary. 4.2 Pulmonary Function Test (`PULM-PFT`): Patients must withhold short-acting bronchodilators for 6 hours prior to testing and long-acting bronchodilators for 24 hours prior to testing, unless otherwise specified by the attending physician. Patients shall not consume heavy meals within 2 hours or smoke within 6 hours of the test. 4.3 Bronchoscopy (`PULM-BRON`): Patients must observe strict nil per os (NPO) status starting exactly 8 hours prior to the scheduled procedure time. Anticoagulant and

antiplatelet medications must be managed in accordance with the Pre-Procedure Medication Cessation Schedule maintained by Nursing Operations.

5. Procedure Codes, List Prices, and Plan Coverage Matrix 5.1 Coverage tiers, list prices, and pre-authorisation requirements across the four Meridian plans are mandated as follows:

Code & Description	List Price	Service Duration	Plan	Coverage Status	Pre-Authorisation Requirement
PULM-CONS Pulmonology Consultation	$200	30 minutes	MERIDIAN-GOLD MERIDIAN-SILVER MERIDIAN-BRONZE CIVIC-BASE	Covered Covered Covered Covered	No pre-authorisation No pre-authorisation No pre-authorisation No pre-authorisation
PULM-PFT Pulmonary Function Test	$310	45 minutes	MERIDIAN-GOLD MERIDIAN-SILVER MERIDIAN-BRONZE CIVIC-BASE	Covered Covered Covered Covered	No pre-authorisation No pre-authorisation No pre-authorisation No pre-authorisation
PULM-BRON Bronchoscopy	$3,400	60 minutes	MERIDIAN-GOLD MERIDIAN-SILVER MERIDIAN-BRONZE CIVIC-BASE	Covered Covered Covered Covered	Pre-authorisation in 2 business days Pre-authorisation in 3 business days Pre-authorisation in 5 business days Pre-authorisation in 7 business days

5.2 No additional pulmonology procedures outside of codes `PULM-CONS`, `PULM-PFT`, and `PULM-BRON` may be scheduled without prior written authorization from the Department Chair, Dr. Aris Thorne.